

Week 1 Assignment: Foundations Freewrite

CFAN 3091V | Interest, Motivation, and Direction

Due: Bring one printed copy to class Monday, September 14. You will use it during the topic-funnel activity and hand it in at the end of class.

Purpose

This freewrite gives you useful material for the Week 2 topic-funnel exercise. You are not expected to arrive with a settled thesis topic. The assignment asks you to notice what holds your attention, why it matters to you, and what you may want to investigate next.

What to Write

Write informally about:

1. problems, systems, questions, or experiences that hold your attention;
2. why those interests matter to you;
3. what motivates you to investigate or work on them;
4. the kinds of activities or work you enjoy doing;
5. a role, job, profession, or career that might involve that kind of work;
6. what you already know and what you would need to explore; and
7. one uncertainty you want help thinking through.

This is exploratory writing. It does not need a research question, faculty names, citations, or polished prose.

Format

- 1–2 pages
- Times New Roman, 12 point
- double spaced, with one-inch margins
- continuous line numbers
- single-sided printing
- your name, the date, and the title at the top
- page numbers if the response is longer than one page
- no cover page and no reference list

How to Submit

Bring one printed copy to class. You will use the freewrite during the topic-funnel activity and hand it to the instructor at the end of class. It will be returned Wednesday with a **Satisfactory** or **Not Yet Satisfactory** result and brief feedback. The result will appear in the Canvas gradebook, but there is no routine Canvas upload for this assignment.

If an absence or access need makes the paper hand-in unworkable, contact the instructor for a digital alternative.

This Freewrite is the second participation component of Milestone 1. The first is the Course-Track Survey submitted before the September 9 meeting. Milestone 1 is complete when the survey has been submitted and this Freewrite meets the standard below. The Freewrite is not evaluated for technical polish.

Satisfactory Standard

The freewrite is satisfactory when it:

- responds specifically to the prompts rather than listing topics alone;
- identifies at least one meaningful interest or motivation;
- connects that interest to a possible kind of work, role, or future direction; and
- names something you still need to explore or one uncertainty you want help thinking through.

Grammar, certainty, and having a settled topic are not evaluated.

Fall Graduation Track

Use the same freewrite through the thesis you are already completing. Address why the project mattered, how it connects to work or a future direction, what still motivates you, what you have learned about the work you want to do, and the most important uncertainty or threat to completion. The same format, submission process, and satisfactory standard apply.